

Friday, 2 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

20° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

19° 13°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

19° 14°

GLASGOW

Rain

17° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 HMRC is being urged to scrutinise the tax implications of the Manchester City financial verdict.

The Treasury Committee wants the tax body to investigate the financial aspects of the Premier League's ruling against the club. This comes after Manchester City were found guilty of breaching financial rules.

FINANCE · UK

2 A former teacher from the Channel 4 series 'Educating Cardiff' has admitted to sexually assaulting a teenage girl.

Gareth Ritter, who featured prominently in the popular documentary, pleaded guilty to the serious charge. The incident involved a 17-year-old girl.

CRIME · UK

3 Hundreds of jobs are under threat at the Grangemouth chemical plant in Scotland.

Syngenta, the company operating the plant, stated that its Grangemouth facility is no longer competitive. This is due to increasing competition from overseas markets, putting many livelihoods at risk.

ECONOMY · UK

4 Two men have been jailed for raping a woman in an underground car park.

The horrific incident took place in September 2023 when both men were 17 years old. Parts of the attack were captured on CCTV footage, aiding the investigation.

CRIME · UK

5 Sikh activist Jagtar Singh Johal has been freed on bail after nearly a decade in an Indian prison.

Mr Johal, from Dumbarton, was arrested in 2017 in connection with alleged terror offences. His release follows a long-running campaign for his freedom, raising concerns about his treatment.

HUMAN RIGHTS · UK

What's coming up

1 **The Brit Awards' move to Manchester gave the city a huge economic boost, injecting an estimated £5 million.**

Greater Manchester mayor Bev Craig hailed the awards' first time outside London as a 'massive moment'. It highlights the positive impact major events can have on regional economies.

ON AIR – Is it time for more big awards ceremonies to move out of London and into other UK cities?

MUSIC · WHEN

2 **With Celebrity Traitors back on our screens, many are wondering if they can visit the iconic Scottish castle.**

The show, set in the Scottish Highlands, has captured the public's imagination. A guide has been released to 'Traitors Territory', detailing where fans can explore.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of The Traitors? What makes it such compelling viewing?

TV · NOW

3 **Lizzo says she's 'grateful' after a judge dismissed a lawsuit against her production company.**

The 'About Damn Time' singer expressed her relief at the outcome. She also stated her intention to 'continue to fight' all other claims made against her.

ON AIR – It's been a tough few years for Lizzo. Do you think she can bounce back and regain her huge popularity?

MUSIC · NOW

4 **Celebrity Traitors is back for another series, with a host of famous faces ready to play the ultimate game of deception.**

Maya Jama, Michael Sheen, and Bella Ramsey are among the celebrities taking part this year. Viewers are eagerly anticipating who will be faithful and who will betray.

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on Celebrity Traitors this year? And who do you think will be the best at playing the game?

TV · NOW

5 **US country music star Charles Kelley of Lady A has revealed he's been diagnosed with blood cancer.**

The Grammy-winning singer, 45, said he currently feels 'great' and is 'hopeful' about his prognosis. He thanked fans for their support during this challenging time.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Lady A song? We're sending all our best wishes to Charles.

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 HMRC is facing calls to investigate the tax implications of Manchester City's recent guilty verdict.**
 The Treasury Committee is urging the tax body to scrutinise the financial aspects of the Premier League's ruling. This comes after the club was found guilty of breaching financial rules.
ON AIR – Do you think this latest development could lead to even more serious consequences for Manchester City?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Former Manchester City boss Pep Guardiola says he will 'always' be behind the club following their guilty verdicts.**
 Guardiola, who led City to numerous triumphs, expressed his unwavering support despite the Premier League's findings. The club was found guilty of financial charges.
ON AIR – Do you think Pep Guardiola's loyalty to Manchester City is admirable, or should he be more critical given the circumstances?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Nico O'Reilly has withdrawn from the England squad for their upcoming Nations League games due to injury.**
 The international break will see England play their final two Nations League matches without O'Reilly. His absence is a blow to the squad's preparations.
ON AIR – How much of a loss do you think Nico O'Reilly's injury will be for England in these crucial Nations League fixtures?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Leg-spinner Mason Crane has earned an England recall for the first time in eight years for the Pakistan series.**
 Crane will have the chance to play for England in the one-day international tri-series in Pakistan. It's a significant moment for the bowler, marking a long-awaited return to the national side.
ON AIR – After such a long time away, do you think Mason Crane can make a real impact for England in the upcoming series?
 CRICKET · UK
- 5 Scotland head coach Sebastien Pocognoli faces key decisions as he seeks his first win against North Macedonia.**
 Pocognoli has important choices to make regarding his squad ahead of Saturday's match. Fans will be eager to see if he can guide Scotland to a much-needed victory.
ON AIR – What changes, if any, do you think Sebastien Pocognoli should make to secure Scotland's first win under his leadership?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful new study suggests that 'the satisfying crunch of autumn leaves' underfoot can significantly boost our mood.**

Researchers found that the distinct sound and sensation evoke feelings of nostalgia and connection to nature, acting as a mini-mindfulness moment during daily walks.

- 2 The humble art of 'doodling during meetings' is being re-evaluated as a powerful tool for focus and memory retention.**

Far from being a sign of distraction, experts say that light sketching can help the brain process information and prevent mind-wandering, leading to better recall of key points.

- 3 A charming local initiative encourages people to 'swap homegrown excess produce' with neighbours rather than letting it go to waste.**

It's creating lovely community bonds and ensuring that gluts of courgettes or apples find a happy home, often resulting in delicious new recipes shared too.

- 4 Experts are highlighting 'the calming ritual of watering houseplants' as a surprisingly effective way to de-stress.**

The simple act of caring for something green, combined with the gentle flow of water, provides a tranquil break from screens and busy schedules.

- 5 A charming movement sees people 'collecting unusual old postcards' from forgotten holiday spots and historic towns.**

It's a lovely way to connect with the past and discover snippets of history and travel from yesteryear, often with fascinating handwritten messages on the back.

- 6 The satisfying ritual of 'sharpening pencils by hand' is making a quiet comeback among those seeking a moment of analogue calm.**

Far from being an outdated chore, the focused action and the scent of wood shavings are providing a small, sensory pleasure in our digital world.

- 7 New research suggests that 'the unique smell of old books' can evoke stronger positive memories than almost any other scent.**

Scientists believe the combination of paper, ink, and dust creates a complex aroma that triggers deep-seated feelings of comfort and intellectual curiosity.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new pack of biscuits, especially if it's a fancy selection. What is it?
- ANSWER:** LOOKING AT ALL THE DIFFERENT TYPES AND CAREFULLY PLANNING THE ORDER IN WHICH THEY'LL BE EATEN, FROM LEAST FAVOURITE TO MOST FAVOURITE!

- Q** Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?
- ANSWER:** GIVING THE BOX A GOOD SHAKE TO HEAR HOW CRUNCHY THE FLAKES SOUND, OR PERHAPS EVEN A LITTLE SNIFF THROUGH THE POURING SPOUT!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of shop' just instantly makes you feel nostalgic, perhaps because of its old-fashioned charm or the specific items it sells?
What kind of shop is it for you – an old sweet shop, a traditional hardware store, or maybe a quaint little bookshop – and what memories does it bring back?
- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your life without because it's just so useful or brings you a little bit of joy, don't we?
What's that one item in your home that you secretly adore, from a perfectly ergonomic potato peeler to a brilliantly designed mug, and why is it so indispensable?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A team of scientists recently discovered a species of fish that can climb trees using its fins to grip the bark, but only when it rains.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest; they have been observed flying at altitudes of up to 9,000 metres.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, was buried in one after he died.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one hundredth of a second.
- The British Isles are home to over 150 types of native trees and shrubs.
- The original name for the butterfly was 'flutterby'.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress call.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.

On this day

Day 275 of the year, 90 days left in 2026. Today Batik Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Blessed Antoine Chevrier; Christian feast day: Denha I of Tikrit (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Jan Beyzym. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Badly Drawn Boy, English musician
- 1976 — Mark Chilton, English cricketer
- 1967 — Gillian Welch, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1956 — Freddie Jackson, American soul singer
- 1948 — Avery Brooks, American actor
- 1952 — Robin Riker, American actress
- 1973 — Efren Ramirez, American actor
- 1949 — Richard Hell, American singer-songwriter and bass player

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — Five Amish girls are murdered in a shooting at a school in Pennsylvania, United States.
- 1970 — An aircraft carrying the Wichita State University football team, administrators, and supporters crashes in Colorado, killing 31 people.
- 1971 — British European Airways Flight 706 crashes near Aarsele, Belgium, killing 63.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1980 — Michael Myers becomes the first member of either chamber of Congress to be expelled since the Civil War.
- 2007 — President Roh Moo-hyun of South Korea goes to North Korea for an Inter-Korean summit with North Korean leader Kim Jong-il.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1944 — World War II: German troops end the Warsaw Uprising.
- 1971 — British European Airways Flight 706 crashes near Aarsele, Belgium, killing 63.

- 2002 — The Beltway sniper attacks begin in Washington, D.C., extending over three weeks and killing 10 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 276 of the year, 89 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Adalgott; Christian feast day: Ambrósio Francisco Ferro; Christian feast day: Blessed Szilárd Bogdánffy. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — G. Love, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and harmonica player
- 1970 — Jimmy Ray, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1979 — Josh Klinghoffer, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1995 — Ayo Edebiri, American actress
- 1975 — India Arie, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1934 — Benjamin Boretz, American composer and theorist
- 1981 — Matt Sparrow, English footballer
- 1964 — Clive Owen, English actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2024 — Bengali, Assamese, Marathi, Pali and Prakrit are accorded the Classical language status by the Government of India
- 1949 — WERD, the first black-owned radio station in the United States, opens in Atlanta.
- 2023 — Wab Kinew is elected to be the first First Nations Premier of a Canadian province in the 2023 Manitoba general election

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1946 — An American Overseas Airlines Douglas DC-4 crashes near Ernest Harmon Air Force Base in Stephenville, Newfoundland and Labrador, Canada, killing 39.
- 2024 — Bengali, Assamese, Marathi, Pali and Prakrit are accorded the Classical language status by the Government of India

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 **Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller**

FRI 23 **Frankenstein (del Toro)**

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar